RuboCop is highly customizable. It ships with dozens of individual style rules, which it calls "cops," plus there's a plugin system to add sets of rules and a mechanism for writing your own rules. After adding RuboCop, in theory you have just one discussion among your team to set RuboCop's preferences, and then you let RuboCop handle the style-checking rather than continually debating it in code review.

RuboCop's documentation[2] is thorough. It includes a description of every individual cop with examples of code that passes and fails each one.

Getting Started with Rubocop

Let's look at how to get started using RuboCop in your code. For demonstration purposes, we're going to go through the process of adding RuboCop to our Aaagmnr gem from Chapter 15, Ruby Gems, on page 251. RuboCop is a Ruby gem, so you first need to add it to the Gemfile as `gem "rubocop"`. (If you are literally following along with a copy of Aaagmnr, note that the previous version had Standard installed. Here, we're replacing it with Rubocop for sake of the demonstration.)

Next, run `bundle install` to have a command-line program called `rubocop`:

```
$ rubocop
Inspecting 14 files
CCCCCCCCCCCCCC

Offenses:
Gemfile:3:8: C: [Correctable] Style/StringLiterals:
 Prefer single-quoted strings when you don't need
 string interpolation or special symbols.
source "https://rubygems.org"
       ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^

<LOTS OF THOSE>

14 files inspected, 108 offenses detected, 102 offenses auto-correctable

Tip: Based on detected gems, the following RuboCop extension libraries
     might be helpful:
  * rubocop-rake (https://rubygems.org/gems/rubocop-rake)
  * rubocop-rspec (https://rubygems.org/gems/rubocop-rspec)

You can opt out of this message by adding the following to your config
(see https://docs.rubocop.org/rubocop/extensions.html#extension-suggestions
     for more options):
  AllCops:
    SuggestExtensions: false
```

If you are using the sample code that came with this book, you will only get these results if you remove or rename the configuration files `.rubocop.yml` and `.rubocop_todo.yml` described later in this chapter. Also, newer versions of RuboCop may change this output.

Let's parse this. RuboCop first tells us how many Ruby files it found to inspect—14 in this case. Then it gives us a running progress bar. If this was a live video and not a book, you'd see those `C`'s coming in one at a time.

2. https://docs.rubocop.org/rubocop/1.38/index.html